

Conditions of Ibadah

Conditions of Ibadah are divided into two types:

1. Main or primary conditions
2. Secondary conditions

Main Conditions (Primary):

1. Must have Iman: ‘Iman’ is to believe in all things that Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) received from Allah (SWT) in our Soul, agree with our Mouth, and practice in our practical life. No Ibadah is accepted without Iman.

“And We shall turn to whatever deeds they did (in this life), and We shall make such deeds as floating dust scattered about.”
[Surah Furqan: 23]

2. Must have Ikhlas (Sincerity): Ikhlas means to perform Ibadah exclusively and sincerely for Allah (SWT). It is necessary that our action is done with ‘Iman’ in Allah (SWT) and complete Ikhlas to Him (SWT), so that we do not make anyone a partner with Him.

“Say: Indeed, I have been commanded to perform ‘Ibadah to Allah (SWT) making the ‘Deen’ sincerely for Him alone” [Surah Zumar: 11]

3. Pure intention: The intention must be fixed to get satisfaction of Allah (SWT).

It was narrated by Umar (RA): “The reward of deeds depends on the intentions...” [Bukhari: 01].

From a Hadith-e-Qudsi reported by Muslim: "...whoever does an action for someone else's sake as well as Mine, will have that action rejected by Me to him whom he associated with Me"

4. Mutaba'tur Rasul: It means to follow Prophet (ﷺ) in practical life.

"Say: 'Obey Allah (SWT) and His Messenger': But if they turn back, Allah (SWT) will not love those who reject faith." [Surah Ali Imran: 32]

Ibadah should be practiced by direction of Shariah; by following the way of Prophet (ﷺ). Otherwise it will not be counted as 'Ibadah in the scale of Shariah. It is narrated by 'Aysa (RA), she said: Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said: "Who practices any work, which is not selected by Shariah, it will be avoided," [Bukhari: 2550].

5. Ilm (Knowledge): We have to acquire pure knowledge regarding our Ibadah before practicing it in our practical life.

It is reported from Al-Hasan (RA), he said: The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: "The man should know the knowledge and work with it and teach him". Al-Ash'ath said: "Do you not see that he started with knowledge before work?"

Secondary Conditions:

1. Avocation in Halal ways: It includes foods, drinks, dresses...etc. Muslims must be careful about foods, drinks and clothes; because all Ibadah will be valueless if they are acquired through invalid ways.

It is narrated by Abu Hurairah (RA), Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said: “Verily Allah (SWT) is noble, and He does not accept anything without noble... after that he mentioned the man who travels a long distance, his hair is sporadic, extends his two hands to the heaven and says: Oh my Lord! Oh my Lord! His foods, drinks and dresses are illegal, his lifestyle is illegal, then how will his his prayer be accepted?” [Muslim: 1015]

2. Not disobeying Allah (SWT): To save from big sins specially is necessary for our ‘Ibadah to be accepted.

“If you avoid the great (things) which you are forbidden, We will remit from you your evil deeds and make you enter at a noble gate” [4: 31].

3. Not Showing off: Showing and hearing our activities in terms of Ibadah is minor shirk and shirk rejects our deeds.

“I am full free from association of Musrikin (who makes share with Allah (SWT)), so who performs any work with sharing in it, then I leave him and his shirk” [Muslim: 2985].

4. Disobeying parents: Disobedience of parents is the greatest sin, so any Ibadah with disobeying their legal conditions, will not be acceptable to Allah (SWT).

Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ), he said: “The greatest sins are: shirk (associate with Allah (SWT)), disobedience of parents, killing a person without lawful cause and illegal Testifying”, [Nasayee: 3473].

5. Fulfilling Ibadah with heart and soul: Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said: “Surely, Allah (SWT) loves when one from you does work nicely with heart and soul” [Baihaki: 4386]

6. Practicing all good deeds: Righteous work is compulsory while doing Ibadah. It is a wrong attitude to think that Ibadah will be accepted with evil actions in it.

Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) said: “O men! Verily Allah (SWT) is noble, and he doesn’t accept anything without noble” [Muslim: 1015].

7. Favour from Allah (SWT): From the greatest condition is favour from Allah (SWT). If Allah (SWT) does not favour and accept our Ibadah, nothing can make it accepted.

8. Fulfilling pre-conditions of some Ibadah: We have to fulfill all pre-conditions of some ‘Ibadahs, like: Purity and other pre-conditions of Salah (Prayer), fixed amount and duration of Zakah, free from exemptions of Sawm, capability for Hajj ..., so without fulfilling these pre-conditions our ‘Ibadah may not be accepted by Allah (SWT).